

That was a long time ago. But most of us today still assume that life elsewhere is too good to be true. We make excuses about why we can't move. We put up with bad air, traffic, high prices, and cockroaches where we are now. But does it make sense to continue to struggle in San Francisco, Philadelphia, or Boston? If you're 40 years old, you have over half of your active adult life ahead of you. Do you really want to spend it on the Lexington Avenue Express or the Garden Grove Freeway?

Some years ago Vicki and I went to a birthday party in an Italian part of Brooklyn where it seemed everybody was related to everyone else. Talk centered around Dick and Angela's upcoming move. It would be so hard on everyone. Grandma would see the baby less. Dick would drop by less often. Angela would have her next child without her mother nearby. It was all quite sad, until I finally met Dick and asked where he was moving.

"Queens."

We all want to live near people we know and love. But family and friends tend to move around. About 25 percent of Americans move every year. Sometimes it's across the street, but many times it's across the country or even out of the country. And just because you move doesn't mean you'll never see your friends again. When you're retired you can travel for months on end. You'll have plenty of time to visit friends and relatives on *their* schedule, fitting in with *their* lives. Since Vicki and I retired we feel we've become closer to our friends. We spend huge blocks of time with them, typically several *days* rather than hours. We are often welcome as houseguests. That way we're around to chat when *they* have the time, even if it's only an hour or so between "after work" and "at the gym."

CONTROL YOUR HOUSING COSTS

You move to cut your housing costs. I'm talking about extremes here. In college calculus we found that as a curve slopes toward a line, it gets closer and closer. How close?